

Kinvarra Cardigan

by Cristina T. Ghirlanda

Kinvarra is a classic drop shoulder cardigan. It is worked seamlessly from the top down. The neckline is added last to give you the maximum finishing flexibility. The sleeves are designed to be fitted. The front and back neck are shaped similarly so that you can also wear this cardigan back-to-front.

Kinvarra Cardigan is graded with inclusive sizing in mind, designed to fit actual bust sizes from 76 cm / 30 inches to 168 cm / 66 inches. Measurements are given in both cm and inches.

Materials

Yarn

Lace weight mohair yarn + fingering weight = heavy DK weight

1. Fingering weight

Yardage: 1125 (1325, 1435, 1550, 1795) {1915, 2060, 2175, 2475, 2580} m / 1230 (1450, 1565, 1695, 1960) {2095, 2255, 2380, 2710, 2825} yds, including 10% allowance

Shown here: Wild Atlantic Yarns Oonagh 4-ply (100% merino; 400 m / 437 yds, 100 g / 3.53 oz skein; color: Beechwood): 3 (4, 4, 4, 5) {5, 6, 6, 7, 7} skeins¹

2. Lace weight mohair yarn

Yardage: 870 (1020, 1105, 1195, 1380) {1480, 1590, 1680, 1910, 1990} m / 950 (1120, 1210, 1305, 1510) {1615, 1740, 1835, 2090, 2175} yds, including 10% allowance

Shown here: Wild Atlantic Yarns Sorcha Kidsilk Lace (72% mohair, 28% silk; 420 m / 459 yds, 50 g / 1.76 oz skein; color: Conker Gathering): 3 (3, 3, 3, 4) {4, 4, 4, 5, 5} skeins²

Both yarns are used in the pattern.

¹For sizes - (-, -, -, -) {-, 7, -, 9, 10} only, an extra skein is added to account for allowance.

²For size 1 only, an extra skein is added to account for allowance.



Notions

9 (10, 10, 10, 11) {11, 11, 11, 12, 12} shank buttons about 1 cm / $\frac{3}{8}$ inch in diameter; locking stitch markers; stitch markers; waste yarn; yarn needle

Needles

4.5 mm / US 7 circular needle of length 80-100 cm / 32-40 inches, depending on your size; adjust needle size if necessary to obtain gauge.

4.5 mm / US 7 needles in your preferred style for small circumference knitting in the round, for the sleeves.

3.5 mm / US 4 circular needle of length 80-100 cm / 32-40 inches, depending on your size, for the hem and neckline.



Gauge

20 sts and 27 rows = 10 cm / 4 inches in Stockinette stitch, blocked.

Sizes

Size 1 (2, 3, 4, 5) {6, 7, 8, 9, 10} designed to fit actual bust circumference of 76 (86.5, 96.5, 106.5, 117) {127, 137, 147.5, 157.5, 167.5} cm / 30 (34, 38, 42, 46) {50, 54, 58, 62, 66} inches.

This garment is intended to be worn with about 16.5 - 20.5 cm / 6½-8 inches positive ease.

Shown in size 1, modeled with 17 cm / 6¾ inches of positive ease.

Finished Measurements

Bust circumference (*buttoned*): 96 (106, 116, 126, 136) {146, 156, 166, 178, 186} cm /

37¾ (41¾, 45¾, 49½, 53½) {57½, 61½, 65¼, 70, 73¼} inches

Required Skills

Decreases, increases, picking up stitches, short rows

Abbreviations

BO - bind off

BOR - beginning of round

CO - cast on

dec('d) - decrease(d)

inc('d) - increase(d)

k - knit

k2tog - knit two together

m1L - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from back to front and place it on left needle, knit into the back of the new stitch.

m1Lp - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from back to front and place it on left needle, purl into the back of the new stitch.

m1R - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from front to back and place it on left needle, knit into the front of the new stitch. See video <https://youtu.be/EvYvGLoPioE>

m1Rp - With right needle, lift the strand between the stitch just worked and the next stitch from front to back and place it on left needle, purl into the front of the new stitch.

p2tog - purl two stitches together

p - purl

RS - right side

ssk - slip 2 sts individually as if to knit, then knit them together through the back loops

ssp - Slip 2 sts individually as if to knit, return them to the left needle, then purl them together through the back loops.

st(s) - stitch(es)

WS - wrong side

yo - yarn over

[...] n times - work the bracketed section n times

Stitch Guide



Figure 1

Backwards Loop Cast-On: (*See Fig. 1*) Hold your needle in your right hand. Grasp the working yarn in your left hand. Pass the working yarn around your left thumb from back to front. Slip the right needle tip under the loop around your thumb. Pull your thumb out of the loop and tug on the working yarn to tighten up the stitch.

Knitted-on Cast-On: (*See video <https://youtu.be/QW99B2XTluc>*) *Knit into first stitch but without releasing it from left needle, then insert the tip of left needle from right to left into the new stitch (*thus transferring it to left needle*). Repeat from * until the required number of stitches are on the needle, lightly tightening the stitches as you go along.



Long-tail Cast-On: With a yarn tail about 3 times the width that you have to CO, holding yarn end on your thumb, work as in this video: <https://youtu.be/ixBylV-PKOM>

Short Row Turn: The sample uses yarn over short rows, which are worked as follows: Work as instructed to the turning point. Turn work. (Alternatively, see video tutorial here <https://youtu.be/I17gPsK7c1Q>)

- ❖ If the first stitch is a purl stitch, make a normal yarn over on the right needle (*i.e.*, wrapping the yarn from the front towards the back of the right needle, bring yarn forward and then purl as usual).
- ❖ If the first stitch is a knit stitch, make a backwards yarn over on the right needle (*i.e.*, wrapping the yarn from back towards the front of the right needle, bring yarn back and then knit as usual).
- ❖ On subsequent short rows, work the yarn over together with the stitch following it using k2tog on a RS row or ssp on a WS row. It won't be mentioned in the pattern.
- ❖ When the pattern says work to x stitches beyond previous turning position, you also count the double stitch if you are using yarn over short rows. If you use another short-row technique, you could place a stitch marker when you turn your work so that you know exactly where to start counting.

Directions

Notes:

- ❖ All videos linked in the pattern are for auxiliary purposes. You do not need to watch them unless you find the written instruction not clear enough.
- ❖ It is strongly advised to highlight or circle the numbers related to your size, with so many sizes available it is easy to make mistakes otherwise.

Left Back (as worn)

Note: Left Back refers to the side that goes on your left shoulder when worn (see Fig.2). If you have difficulties distinguishing Left and Right, add a label to your knitting when you're done with this section.

With larger needle (4.5 mm / US 7) use the long-tail method (see *Stitch Guide*) to CO 27 (29, 31, 33, 35) {37, 39, 41, 45, 47} sts.

Short row 1 (WS): P6 (7, 8, 8, 9) {9, 10, 8, 9, 9}, short row turn.

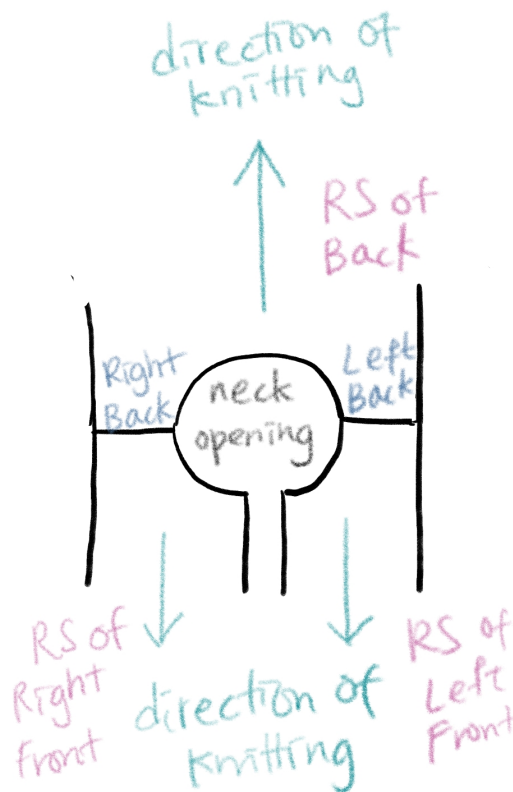


Figure 2: Your knitting viewed from above with RS facing

Short row 2 (RS): Knit to end.

Short row 3 (WS): Purl to yo, resolve yo using ssp, p5 (6, 7, 7, 8) {8, 9, 7, 8, 8} (*i.e.*, you are now 6 (7, 8, 8, 9) {9, 10, 8, 9, 9} sts beyond previous turning point), short row turn.

Short row 4 (RS): Knit to end

Work [Short rows 3-4] 1 (1, 1, 1, 1) {1, 1, 2, 2, 2} more time(s).

Next row (WS): Purl to yo, resolve yo using ssp, purl to end.

Next row (RS): Knit to end.



Neck Shaping

Row 1 (WS): Use the knitted-on method to CO 4 sts, purl the newly cast on stitches, purl to end – 4 sts inc'd.

Row 2 (RS): Knit to end.

Work [Rows 1-2] 3 (3, 3, 3, 4) {4, 5, 5, 5, 5} more times.

You now have 43 (45, 47, 49, 55) {57, 63, 65, 69, 71} sts; a total of 16 (16, 16, 16, 18) {18, 20, 22, 22, 22} rows worked in the Left Back section. (Note: The asterisk is for the Right Front section.)*

Leave stitches on spare needle. Cut yarn.

Right Back (as worn)

Note: Right Back refers to the side that goes on your right shoulder when worn (see Fig.2).

With larger needle (4.5 mm / US 7), use the long-tail method (see *Stitch Guide*) to CO 27 (29, 31, 33, 35) {37, 39, 41, 45, 47} sts.

Row 1 (WS): Purl to end.

Short row 2 (RS): K6 (7, 8, 8, 9) {9, 10, 8, 9, 9}, short row turn (see *Stitch Guide*).

Short row 3 (WS): Purl to end.

Short row 4 (RS): Knit to yo, resolve yo using k2tog, k5 (6, 7, 7, 8) {8, 9, 7, 8, 8} (i.e., you are now 6 (7, 8, 8, 9) {9, 10, 8, 9, 9} sts beyond previous turning point), short row turn.

Short row 5 (WS): Purl to end.

Work [Short rows 4-5] 1 (1, 1, 1, 1) {1, 1, 2, 2, 2} more time(s).

Next row (RS): Knit to yo, resolve yo using k2tog, knit to end.

Neck Shaping

Row 1 (WS): Purl to end.

Row 2 (RS): Use the knitted-on method (see *Stitch Guide*) to CO 4 sts, knit the newly cast on stitches, knit to end – 4 sts inc'd.

Work [Rows 1-2] 3 (3, 3, 3, 4) {4, 5, 5, 5, 5} more times.

You now have 43 (45, 47, 49, 55) {57, 63, 65, 69, 71} sts; a total of 16 (16, 16, 16, 18) {18, 20, 22, 22, 22} rows worked in the Right Back section. (Note: The asterisk is for the Left Front section.)*

Do not cut yarn. Proceed onto the next section.

Back

Continue with the Right Back, purl across Right Back stitches, use the backwards loop method (see *Stitch Guide*) to CO 10 (10, 12, 12, 6) {8, 2, 4, 4, 4} sts, purl across Left Back stitches – 96 (100, 106, 110, 116) {122, 128, 134, 142, 146} sts.

Work even in Stockinette stitch until piece measures 15.5 (17, 18, 19, 19.5) {21, 22, 22.5, 23.5, 24.5} cm / 6 (6 $\frac{3}{4}$, 7, 7 $\frac{1}{2}$, 7 $\frac{3}{4}$) {8 $\frac{1}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 9 $\frac{1}{4}$, 9 $\frac{3}{4}$ } inches along the armhole edge (the outer edge). You can end either after a RS or WS row.

Transfer stitches onto waste yarn. Cut yarn.

Left Front

With RS of Left Back facing and larger needle (4.5 mm / US 7), join yarn, pick up and knit 27 (29, 31, 33, 35) {37, 39, 41, 45, 47} sts (see video <https://youtu.be/ZxrgyQcMbLI>). Work as for Right Back, starting from Row 1 of Right Back up to the asterisk. After completing that section, proceed onto the following rows:

Row 1 (WS): Purl to end.

Row 2 (RS): Use the knitted-on method to CO 7 (7, 8, 8, 5) {6, 3, 4, 4, 4} sts, knit the newly cast on stitches, knit to end – 50 (52, 55, 57, 60) {63, 66, 69, 73, 75} sts.

Row 3 (WS): Purl to last 2 sts, k2.

Row 4 (RS): Knit to end.

Repeat [Rows 3-4] until until piece measures 15.5 (17, 18, 19, 19.5) {21, 22, 22.5, 23.5, 24.5} cm / 6 (6 $\frac{3}{4}$, 7, 7 $\frac{1}{2}$, 7 $\frac{3}{4}$) {8 $\frac{1}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 9 $\frac{1}{4}$, 9 $\frac{3}{4}$ } inches from the shoulder seam along the armhole edge, ending after a RS row. *Note: Optionally, you can place a locking marker at the third stitch on the 16th row (counting from Row 1 of this section), then every 14th row afterwards to mark the button placements so that it's easier to know where to attach the buttons.*

Transfer stitches onto waste yarn. Cut yarn.

Right Front

With RS of Right Back facing and larger needle (4.5 mm / US 7), join yarn, pick up and knit 27 (29, 31, 33, 35) {37, 39, 41, 45, 47} sts (see video <https://youtu.be/txGuXrQOeP0>). Work as for Left Back, starting from Short row 1 of Left Back up to the asterisk. After completing that section, keep stitches



on needle and do not cut yarn. Then proceed onto the next rows:

Row 1 (WS): Use the knitted-on method to CO 7 (7, 8, 8, 5) {6, 3, 4, 4, 4} sts, purl the newly cast on stitches, purl to end – 50 (52, 55, 57, 60) {63, 66, 69, 73, 75} sts.

Row 2 (RS): Knit to end.

Row 3 (WS): K2, purl to end.

Row 4 (RS): Knit to end.

Work [Rows 3-4] five *more* times, then work Row 3 once.

Next row (RS, Buttonhole row): Knit to last 4 sts, ssk then place a locking marker at this stitch, k2 – 1 st dec'd.

Next row (WS): K2, m1Lp, purl to end – 1 st inc'd.

When and how to add buttonholes for the Right Front

From now on throughout the entire pattern, work buttonholes every 14 rows, i.e., one buttonhole row, 13 rows, then another buttonhole row, ...

Work the buttonhole row as follows: Work as instructed in the pattern to last 4 sts, ssk then place a locking marker at this stitch, k2.

Then work the row following the buttonhole row as follows: K2, m1Lp, work as instructed in the pattern.

Continue to add buttonholes as needed, repeat [Rows 3-4] until piece measures 15.5 (17, 18, 19, 19.5) {21, 22, 22.5, 23.5, 24.5} cm / 6 (6 $\frac{3}{4}$, 7, 7 $\frac{1}{2}$, 7 $\frac{3}{4}$) {8 $\frac{1}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 8 $\frac{3}{4}$, 9 $\frac{1}{4}$, 9 $\frac{3}{4}$ } inches from the shoulder seam along the armhole edge, ending after a RS row. Do not cut yarn and proceed onto the next section.

Lower Body

Transfer Back and Left Front stitches onto separate spare needles.

- ❖ If the last row of the Right Front was a buttonhole row, work the Right Front as follows: K2, m1Lp, purl to end; otherwise work the Right Front as: K2, purl to end.
- ❖ use the backwards loop method to CO 0 (6, 10, 16, 20) {24, 28, 32, 36, 40} underarm stitches,
- ❖ purl across Back stitches,
- ❖ use the backwards loop method to CO 0 (6, 10, 16, 20) {24, 28, 32, 36, 40} underarm stitches,

- ❖ purl to last 2 sts of the Left Front, k2 – 196 (216, 236, 256, 276) {296, 316, 336, 360, 376} sts.

Continue to add buttonholes (*see box below*) every 14 rows, at the same time, continue the Lower Body as follows:

Row 1 (RS): Knit to end.

Row 2 (WS): K2, purl to last 2 sts, k2.

Repeat [Rows 1-2] until you have a *total* of 8 (9, 9, 9, 10) {10, 10, 10, 11, 11} buttonholes, ending after a buttonhole row (*a RS row*). *Note: An extra buttonhole will be added in the Neckline section, that is why these numbers are one less than the total number of buttons listed in the Notions section.*

How to add buttonholes in the Lower Body

Work the buttonhole row (RS) as follows: K2, k1 then place a locking marker at this stitch, knit to last 4 sts, ssk then place a locking marker at this stitch, k2. *Note: The first locking marker is for marking button placement and should remain there until you sew on the buttons; the second locking marker is a visual clue to remind you to add buttonholes and can be removed when the next buttonhole is added.*

Then work the WS row following the buttonhole row as follows: K2, m1Lp, purl to last 2 sts, k2.

Next row (WS): K2, m1Lp, purl to about the center back, p2tog, purl to last 2 sts, k2 – 195 (215, 235, 255, 275) {295, 315, 335, 359, 375} sts.

Hem

Change to smaller needle (3.5 mm / US 4).

Row 1 (RS): K2, [p1, k1] to last 3 sts, p1, k2.

Row 2 (WS): K2, [k1, p1] to last 3 sts, k3.

Repeat [Rows 1-2] until ribbing measures 2 cm / $\frac{3}{4}$ inch. You can end after either a RS or WS row.

BO 2 sts knitwise, then BO stitches as they appear to the last 2 sts (*i.e., BO knit stitches knitwise and BO purl stitches purlwise*), BO 2 sts knitwise.

Neckline

Note: When you pick up stitches, pick up from the center of the “V” so that the pick up line is almost invisible.

With RS facing and smaller needle (3.5 mm / US 4), starting from the right front, join yarn, then work as follows (*see video <https://youtu.be/ayMi-jzUWgc>*):



- ❖ (Right Front): Pick up and knit 1 st before the first CO stitch (*the stitch that looks like a “V”*), pick up and knit 1 st for each CO stitch,
- ❖ (Right Shoulder area): pick up and knit 2 sts every 3 rows,
- ❖ (Back): pick up and knit 1 st for each CO stitch,
- ❖ (Left Shoulder area): pick up and knit 2 sts every 3 rows,
- ❖ (Left Front): pick up and knit 1 st for each CO stitch, pick up and knit 1 more stitch.

You should have approximately 112 (112, 116, 116, 120) {124, 128, 136, 136, 136} plus or minus 3 sts.

Row 1 (WS, Buttonhole row): Purl to the last 4 sts, p2tog, p2.

Row 2 (RS): K2, m1L, knit to end.

Row 3 (WS): Evenly decrease 11 sts across as follows:

- ❖ P10 (10, 12, 12, 9) {11, 13, 12, 12, 12}, P2tog,
- ❖ [p7 (7, 7, 7, 8) {8, 8, 9, 9, 9}, p2tog] 10 times, purl to end – 101 (101, 105, 105, 109) {113, 117, 125, 125, 125} sts.

BO all stitches knitwise.

Sleeves

Note: Both sleeves are worked identically.

With larger needle (4.5 mm / US 7), starting at the center of the underarm, pick up and knit 58 (66, 72, 82, 88) {98, 108, 112, 120, 128} sts. Place BOR marker.

Knit 14 (7, 6, 17, 11) {11, 7, 7, 7, 13} rounds.

Next Round (Decrease Round): K2tog, knit to last 2 sts, ssk – 2 sts dec'd.

Work Decrease Round every 10 (8, 7, 8, 8) {8, 8, 8, 6, 10} rounds 9 (12, 14, 3, 3) {4, 3, 2, 1, 3} more time(s).

Then for sizes - (-, -, 4, 5) {6, 7, 8, 9, 10} only, work Decrease Round every - (-, -, 4, 4) {3, 3, 3, 3, 2} rounds - (-, -, 15, 17) {20, 25, 27, 31, 32} times.

You now have 38 (40, 42, 44, 46) {48, 50, 52, 54, 56} sts, a total of 105 (104, 105, 102, 104) {104, 107, 105, 107, 108} rounds worked, decreased a total of 10 (13, 15, 19, 21) {25, 29, 30, 33, 36} times.

Knit even until sleeve measures 42 cm / 16½ inches from the underarm or your desired length.

BO all stitches knitwise. Cut yarn.

Repeat for the other sleeve.

Finishing

Weave in ends. Sew buttons to positions marked by locking markers using a single strand of fingering weight yarn, remove all locking markers. Block to schematic measurements (*see tutorial*). It is recommended to pin the neckline down to prevent it from rolling during blocking.

Acknowledgments and Credits

Technical Editor: Kephren Pritchett

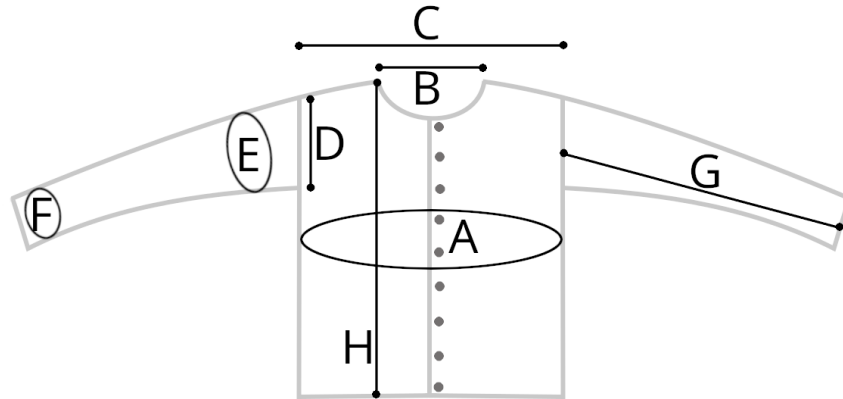
This pattern is a collaboration with Wild Atlantic Yarns.

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(Last Revised: 29th September, 2023)



Schematic



Size		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
A. Bust circumference	cm	96	106	116	126	136	146	156	166	178	186
	inch	37 3/4	41 3/4	45 3/4	49 1/2	53 1/2	57 1/2	61 1/2	65 1/4	70	73 1/4
B. Neck width	cm	19	19	20	20	21	22	23	24	24	24
	inch	7 1/2	7 1/2	7 3/4	7 3/4	8 1/4	8 3/4	9	9 1/2	9 1/2	9 1/2
C. Shoulder width	cm	47	49	52	54	57	60	63	66	70	72
	inch	18 1/2	19 1/4	20 1/2	21 1/4	22 1/2	23 1/2	24 3/4	26	27 1/2	28 1/4
D. Armhole depth*	cm	15.5	17	18	19	19.5	21	22	22.5	23.5	24.5
	inch	6	6 3/4	7	7 1/2	7 3/4	8 1/4	8 3/4	8 3/4	9 1/4	9 3/4
E. Sleeve circumference	cm	29	33	36	41	44	49	54	56	60	64
	inch	11 1/2	13	14 1/4	16 1/4	17 1/4	19 1/4	21 1/4	22	23 1/2	25 1/4
F. Cuff circumference	cm	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28
	inch	7 1/2	7 3/4	8 1/4	8 3/4	9	9 1/2	9 3/4	10 1/4	10 3/4	11
G. Sleeve length	cm	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42	42
	inch	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2	16 1/2
H. Total length	cm	50.5	55.5	55.5	55.5	61.5	61.5	62.5	63	68.5	68.5
	inch	20	22	22	22	24 1/4	24 1/4	24 1/2	24 3/4	27	27

* This measurement refers to the armhole depth measured on the body, before picking up sleeve stitches. When blocking, match your sleeve circumference. The final armhole depth is then determined by the sleeve size.



About the Designer

Cristina lives between Liguria and Tuscany with her sons and husband. She strives to design timeless knitwear, using elements from both classic and contemporary designs. She writes detailed patterns that are easy to follow. To find more about her designs, check out her website MinimiKnitDesign.com. You can also find her as Minimi on Ravelry or as @MinimiKnitDesign on Instagram.



If you share your project on social media, please tag it with #kinvarraCardigan #minimiknitdesign @minimiknitdesign. I would love to see what you make!

